

PROPOSED FEMINIST REPUBLIK HEALING FARM
WINNING COMPETITION ENTRY



PROJECT TITLE
Proposed Feminist Republik
Healing Farm
PROJECT LOCATION
Muselele, Kitui County, Kenya
CLIENT
Urgent Action Fund- Africa (UAF-A)
ARCHITECT
Precise Architects Ltd

PROJECT INTRODUCTION
UAF- Africa set out to establish a
Healing Farm to serve as a
rejuvenation centre for African
Women Human Rights Defenders
across the African continent. The
centre would be a women-run
space used by AWHRDs to connect
with nature and with other AWHRDs
from the continent.

Through a design competition,
Precise Architects set out to
design the healing farm while
being innovative in areas such as
site response, building technology,
material choice, universal design,
sustainable design, representation
of contemporary African
Architecture and the creation of
spaces that promote connection
with nature.

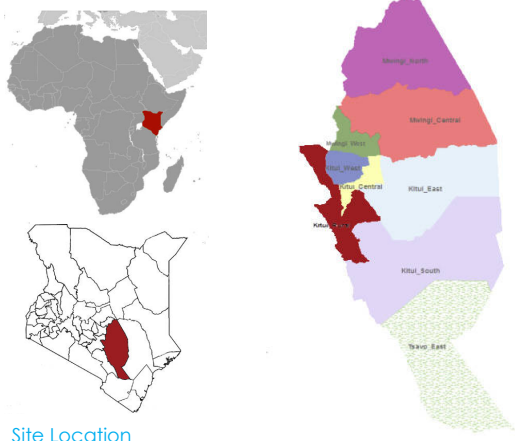
The project features an extensive
brief of spaces which include an
atorium, museum, library,
restaurant, recreational facilities,
sports grounds, accomodation,
camping grounds, meditation
gardens, riverfront boardwalk,
farmland and sculptural gardens
and monument among others.

This entry won first place in the
design competition.

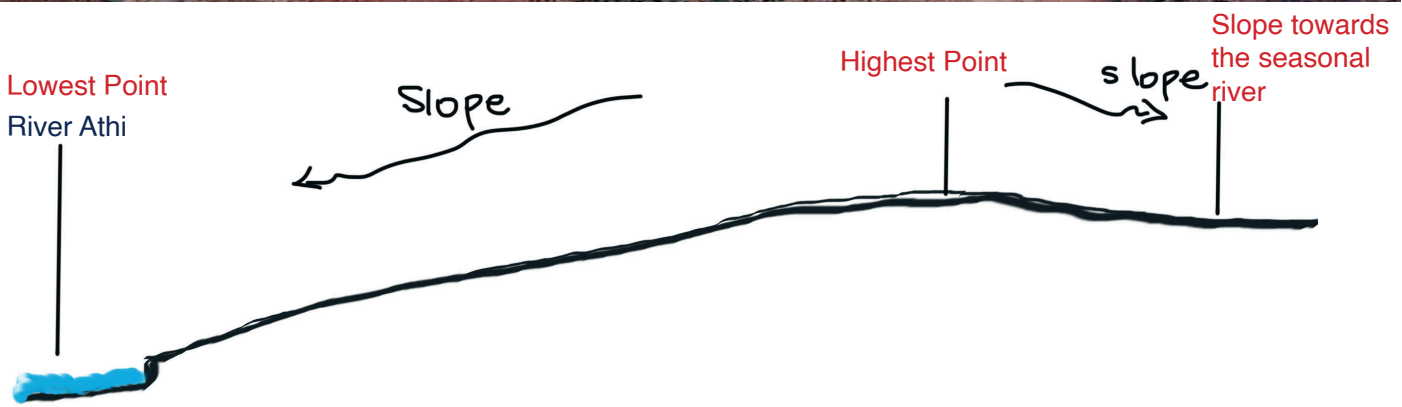
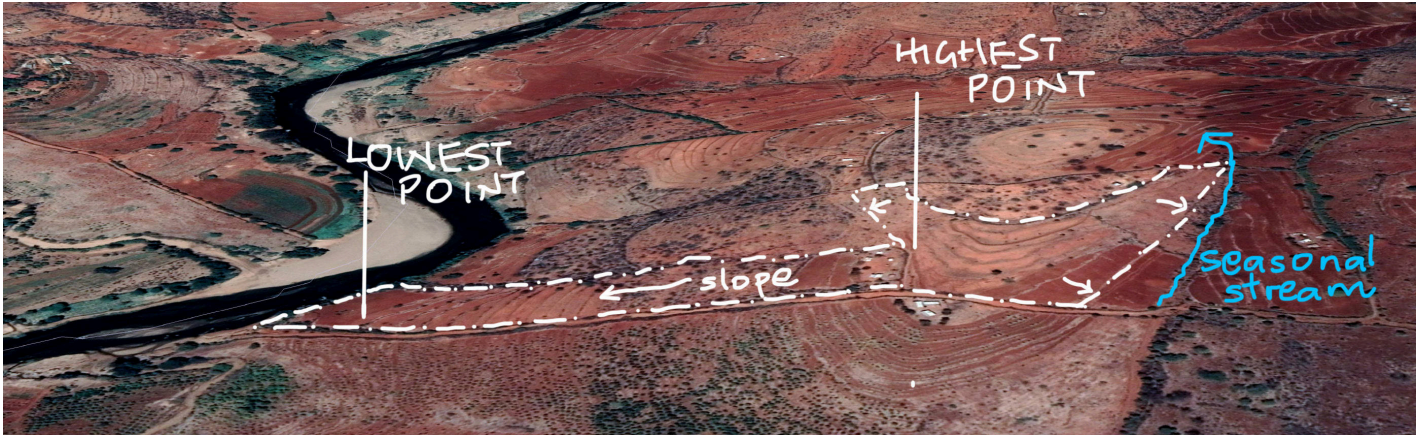


01 THE SITE

SITE LOCATION
The site is located in Kyaina
village, Yatta/Kwa Vonza Ward,
Kitui Rural Constituency, Lower
Yatta Sub-county in Kitui County.
It is about 3.5 km away from
Muselele shopping centre and 25
km from Katangi shopping centre.
The site is located along the Athi
River and borders the river to the
South. It is surrounded by extensive
farmland on all other sides.

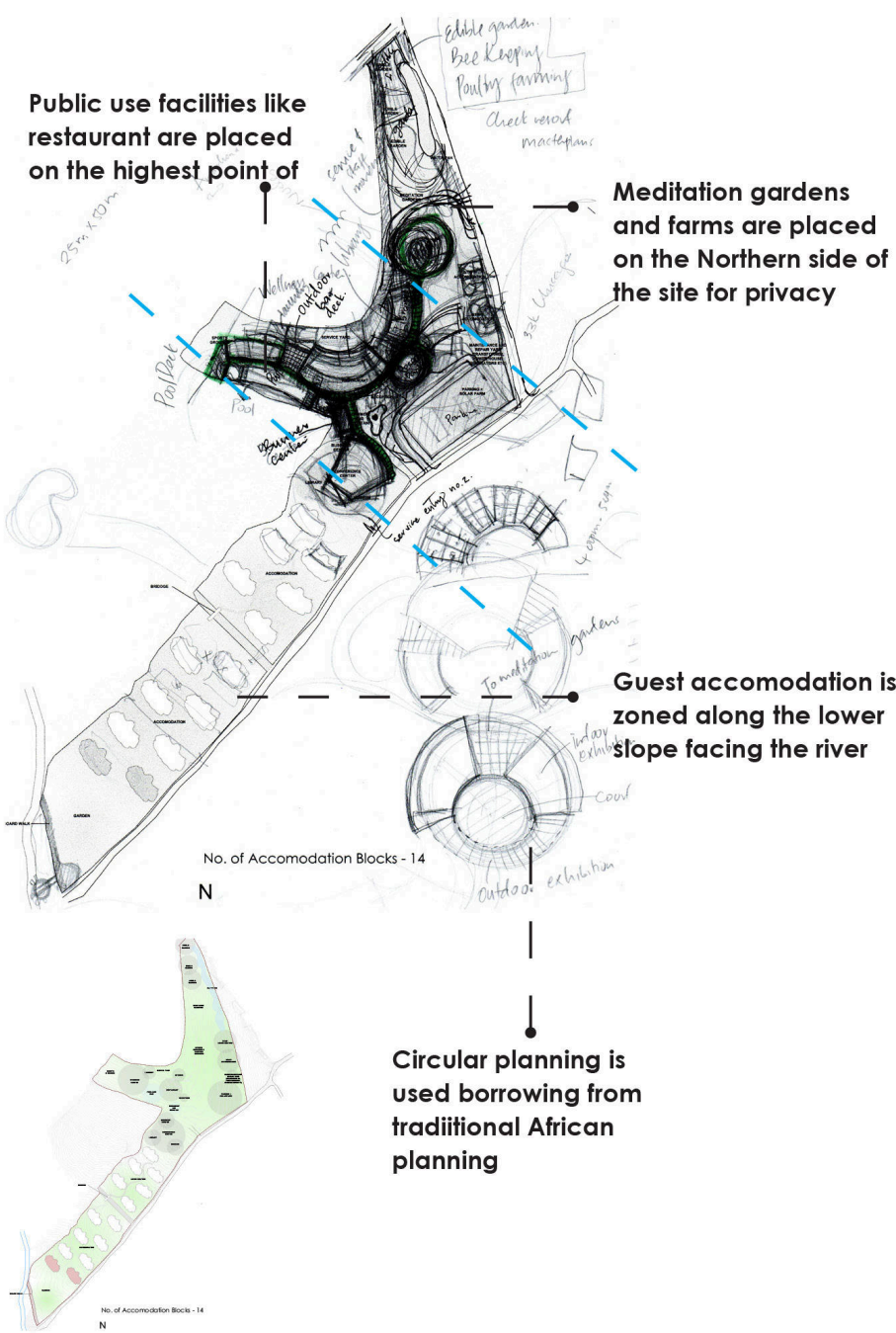


Site Location

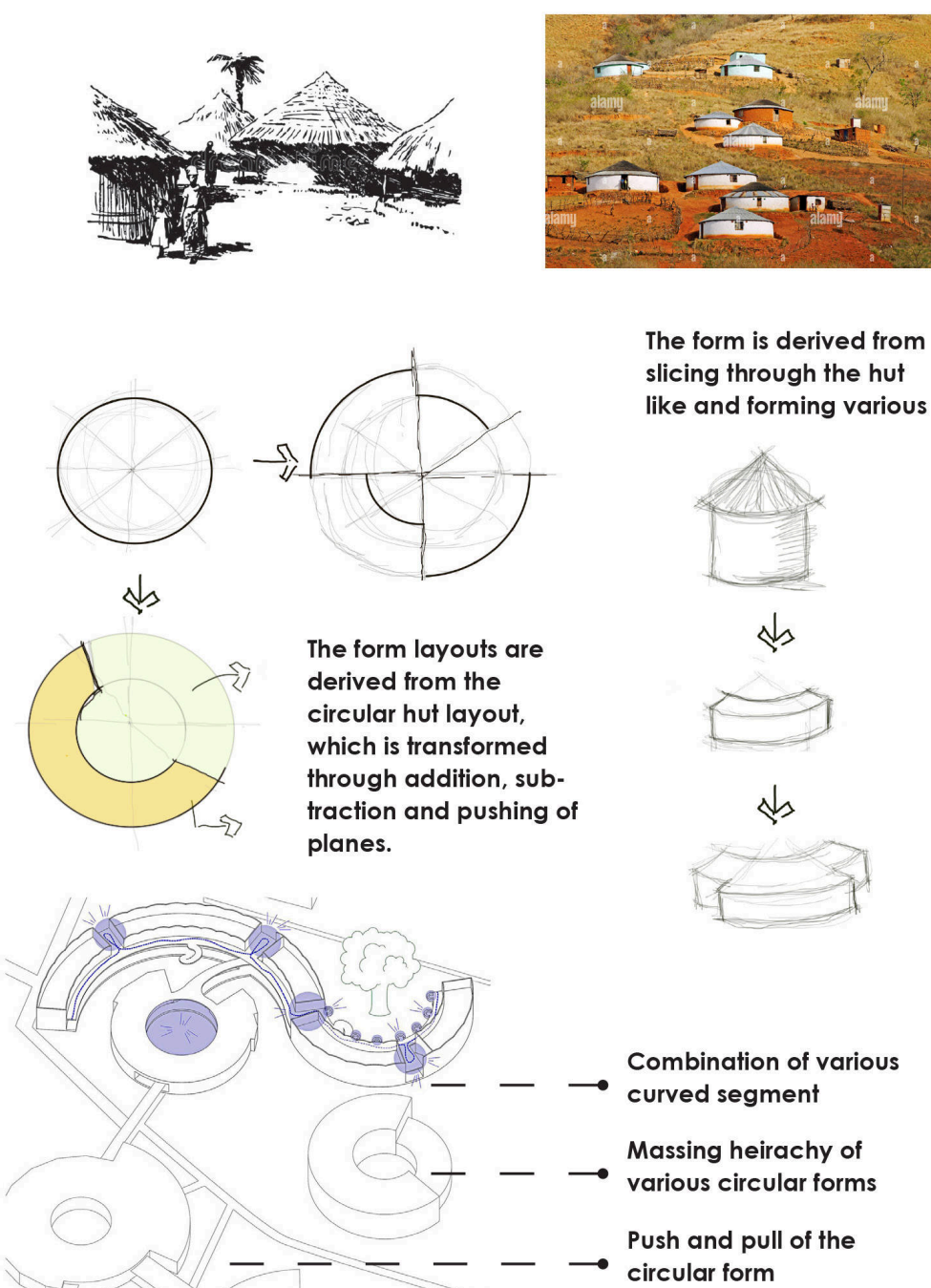


02 CONCEPT DEVELOPMENT

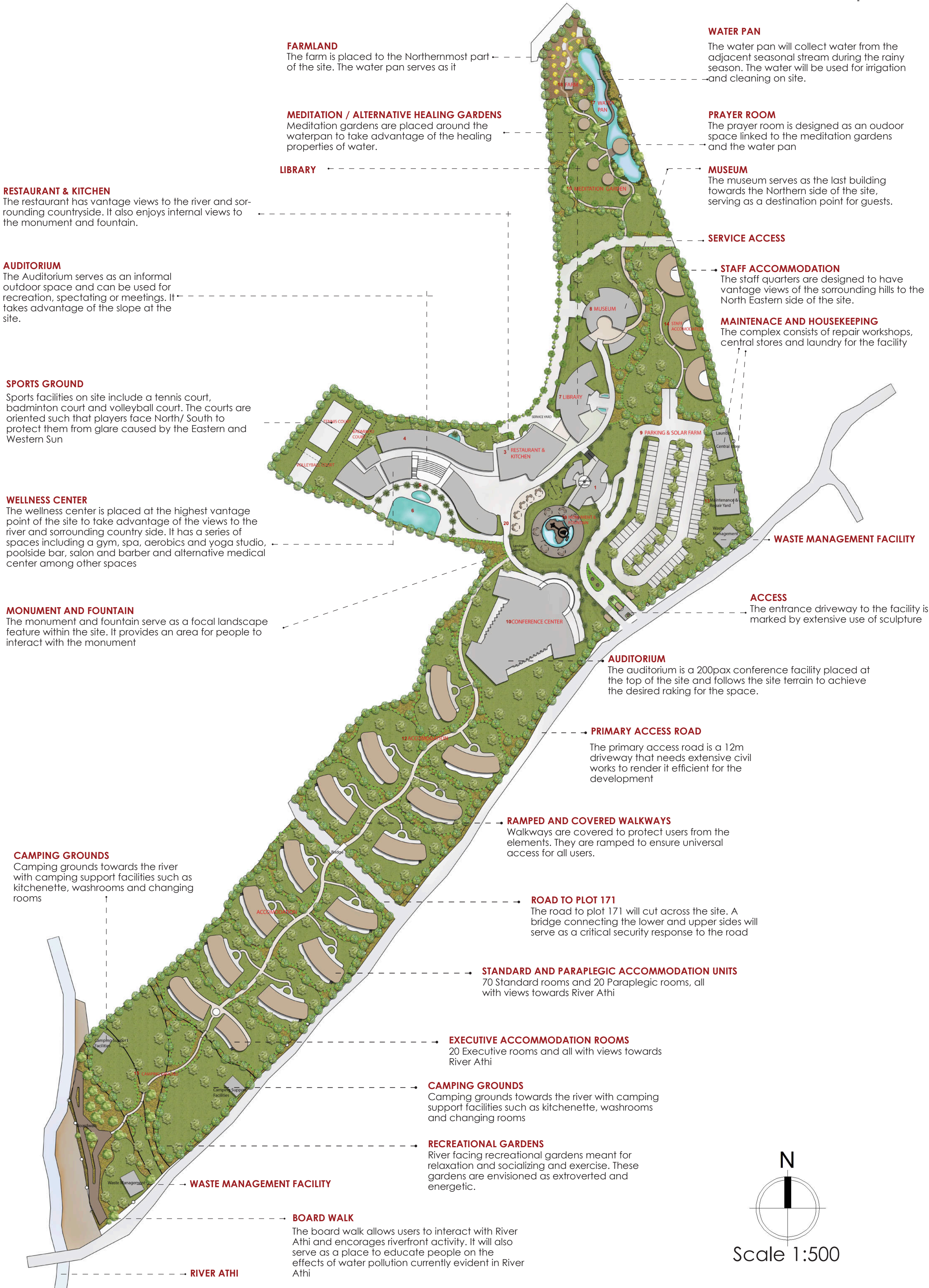
Planning Concept



Form Concept



Master Plan



03 DESIGN STRATEGIES

RESPONSE TO SITE CONDITIONS

The site's distinctive characteristics require an intentional response to design with the site and not against it. Significant conditions include the site's terrain, surrounding physical features and the presence of waterways.

1. Building Along the Countours

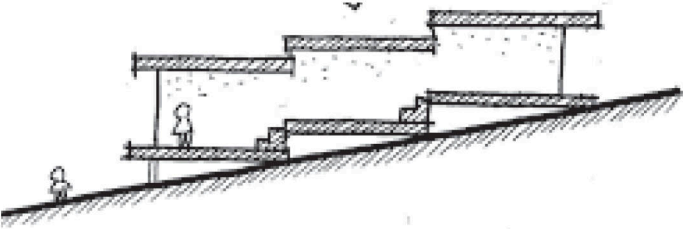
Buildings take advantage of the site's terrain during siting. The buildings and roads on the site follow the contours to prevent extensive cut and fill.

The auditorium uses the site's terrain to achieve the necessary raking for a conference facility.

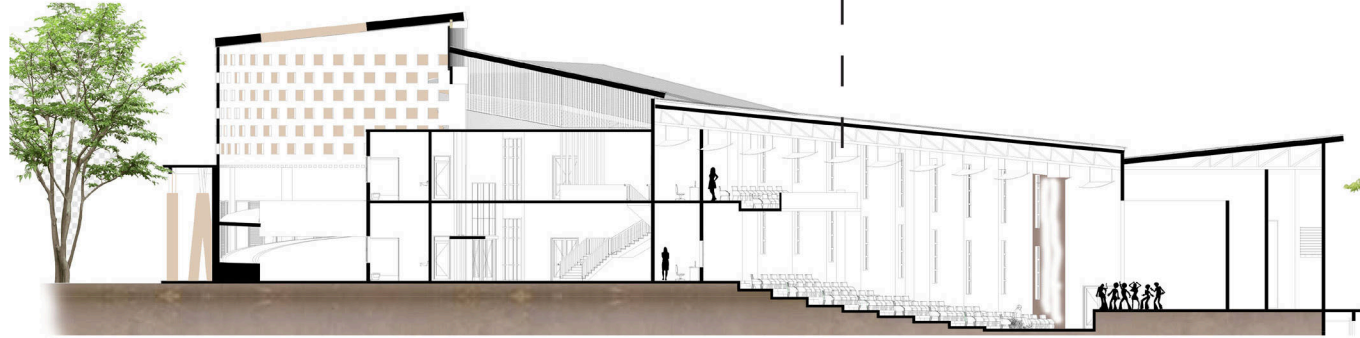


2. Terraced Design

The design terraces the building along the site of the slope to ensure minimal manipulation of the existing terrain. Terraced design also ensures that all buildings along the slope enjoy views without obstructions by adjacent buildings.



View of the auditorium which takes advantage of the site terrain. Raking follows the contours down the slope.



3. Response to the Sorrouding Views

Buildings are oriented to enjoy maximum views to the river and sorrounding countryside on all sides. This is a response to the site's context. While guests enjoy views to Athi River, staff quarters are oriented to enjoy views of the sorrounding hillscape.

4. Planning and the Privacy Gradient

The site's slope informs the planning concept as it relates to privacy gradient. Public spaces such as the auditorium, reception, restaurant, wellness centre and library are located on the highest points of the site. Private spaces for guests (accomodation) are sited along the slope facing Athi River while staff and maintenance spaces are placed on the slope facing the temporary stream. This technique uses the site's terrain to dermacate zones and establish a clear privacy gradient.

5. Response to the Seasonal Stream

The seasonal stream to the North of the site determines the placement of the water pan. The pan is designed to tap water from the stream during the rainy season. The water can then be used on the site for irrigation, cleaning and recreation throughout the year.

6. Response to the Natural Storm Drain

The natural storm drain along the western edge of the site willl serve the site.

7. Response to Athi River

Athi river borders the site to the South. The river front serves as a great destination for the users of the healing farm. The design makes the river a focal point by orienting buildings towards it. Furthermore, the landscape concept creates a boardwalk that allows visitors to experience the river.

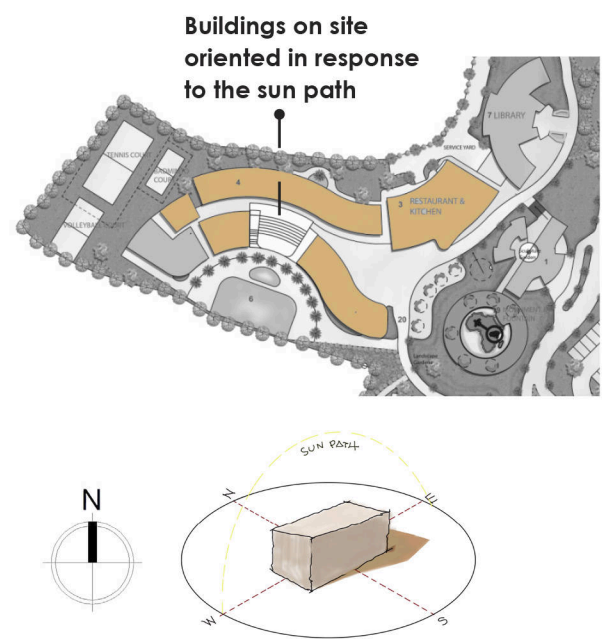
A challenge noted along the river is plastic pollution deposited along the river banks. The project can play a crucial role in safeguarding the river by educating its visitors on the effects of pollution on the River Athi.

ENVIRONMENTAL DESIGN STRATEGIES

The design adopts various strategies to respond to the sites hot and dry climate. The se environmental design strategies seek to ensure thermal comfort in the development while using passive design strategies. The measures adopted are:

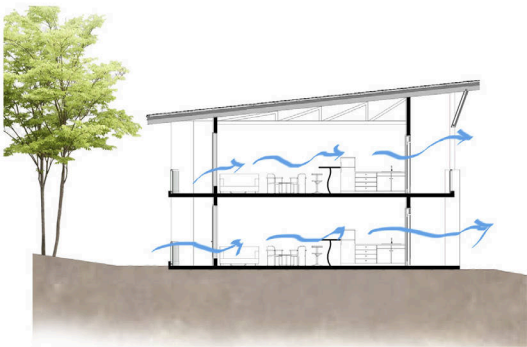
1. Building Orientation

Several buildings on site are oriented with their long facades facing North and South. This minimizes excessive heat gain into by reducing exposure of the building mass to the hot Eastern and Western sun. The illustration below shows a section of the masterplan with the proposed orientation.



2. Single Bunking

The design uses single bunked spaces and avoids double dunked design. The layouts also adopt long narrow buildings to promote cross ventilation and achieve effective cooling within the buildings.



5. Location of Fenestrations

Fenestrations are located extensively along the Northern and Southern facades to minimize heat gain from the Eastern and Western sun. Fenestrations are also sunshaded through the use of balconies and louvres as needed.



VIEW OF THE MUSEUM AND COVERED WALKWAY

4. Stack Ventilation

The buildings have high ceiling heights with both low level and high level openings. The combination of increasing spatial volume and the presence of high level fenestrations esnures effective stack ventilation which cools the spaces effectively.



6. Use of Thermal Mass

The building uses thick external walls, atleast 200mm wide. The walls' thickness create effective time lag, ensuring spaces remain thermally comfortable during the hot afternoons and cold nights.



THE RESTAURANT AND WELLNESS CENTER

MATERIALS SELECTION

The projects uses sustainable materials and follows the following principles im material selection.

1. Locally Available Materials

Materials proposed in the design are locally sourced with a low embodied energy. The primary proposed construction material is **brick** which is locally made within the context of the site. It is the traditionally building material found within the site and its neighbourhood. The design also adopts the use of locally sourced stones found from the extensive rock deposits in the region. These stones will be used for paving walkways, cladding buildings and building landscape works within the project.



Mud brick structure on site



Soil in the site context can produce mud bricks



A selection of local stones found near the site

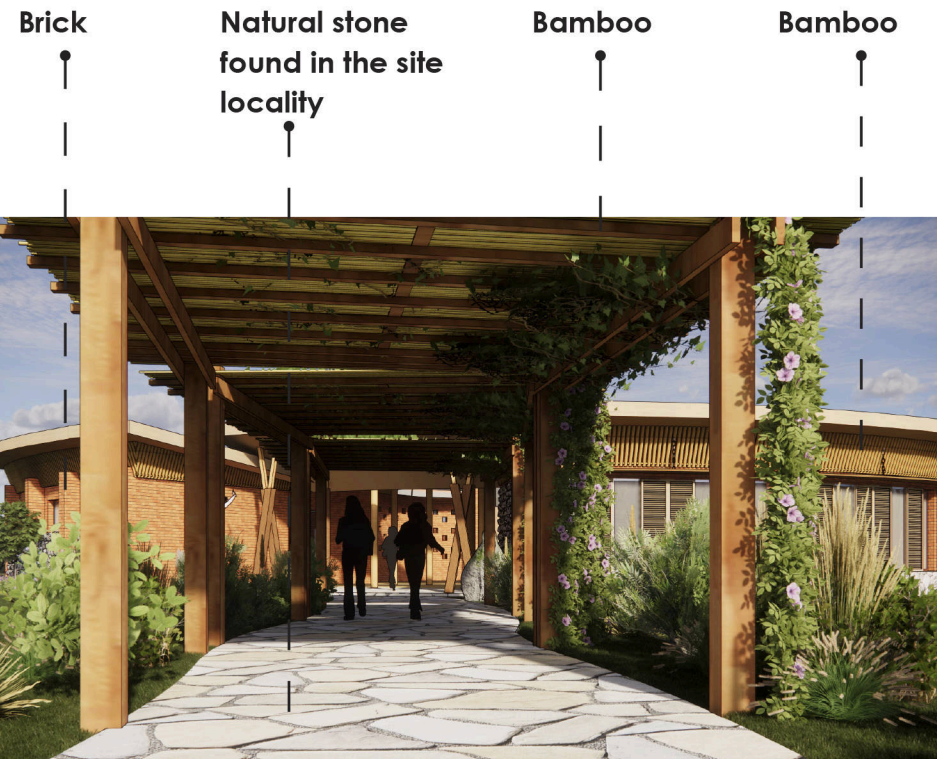


2. Renewable Materials

The design adopts the use of renewable materials. Specifically, railings and covered walkways are built with bamboo, a fast growing timber. These materials are also non-toxic and good for the environment.

3. Healing Materials

The use of natural materials like brick, local stones and bamboo is intended to promote the overall healing effect of the project. These materials are known to have calming effects and create comfortable spaces that rejuvenate and uplift users.



View of Local Materials used on site

SUSTAINABLE DESIGN STRATEGIES

The design considers the following sustainable practices to make the healing farm efficient in its use of energy, water and waste management.

1. Use of Solar Energy



The design proposes a solar farm above the parking structures. Solar energy will reduce the farm's reliance on power from the main grid, saving costs in the long run. It will also reduce the farm's carbon footprint.

2. Water Management

The site lacks adequate water supply from the main grid. The farm will need to have adequate water. The project proposes a borehole for water. Additionally, a water pan will tap water during the rainy season for use on the farm and for irrigation. The project will also promote the use of water saving fixtures in toilets, taps and bathrooms to prevent water wastage by users.

3. Waste Management

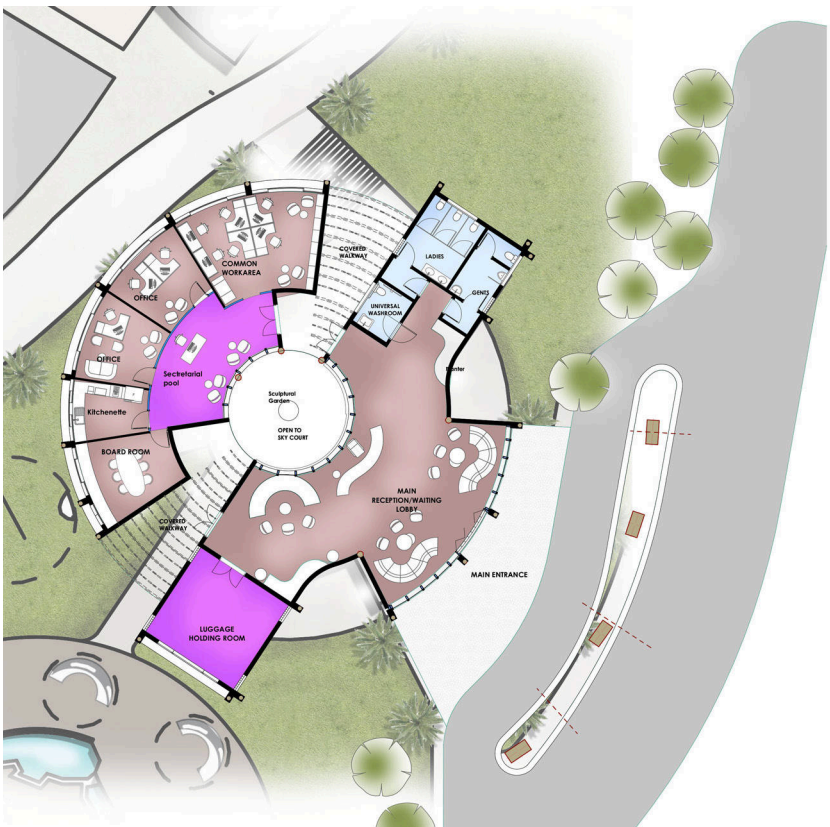
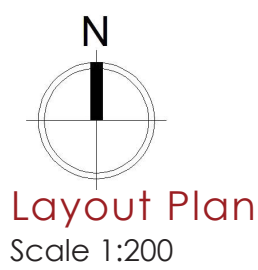
The design proposes two inhouse waste management biodigesters within the site. This will serve the farm which has no access to sewer service. The design also encourages the recycling of grey water within the site for use in landscaping and cleaning of outdoor spaces.

4. Rainwater Harvesting

The design will incorporate extensive rain water harvesting from the building within the site. Water harvested from rains will be directed to the water pan. Rain water harvesting will reduce the cost of supplying water to the site while conserving natural resources.



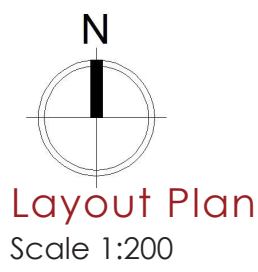
THE RECEPTION & ADMINISTRATION



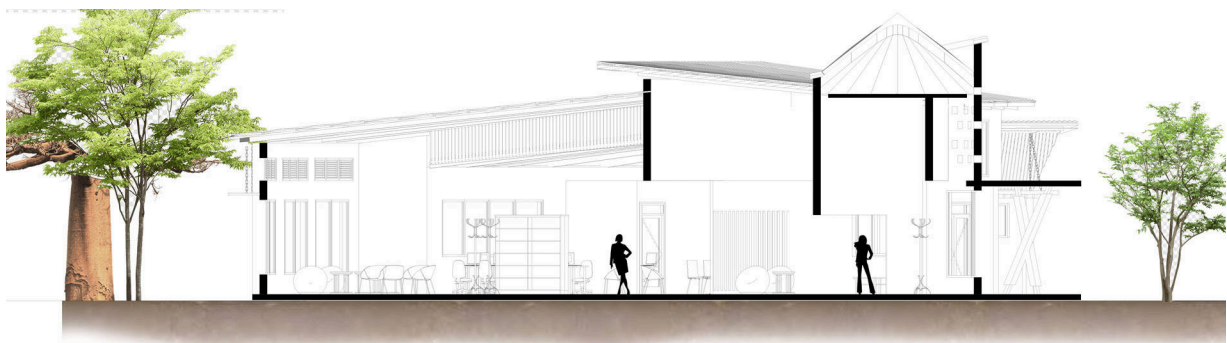
Elevation
Scale 1:200



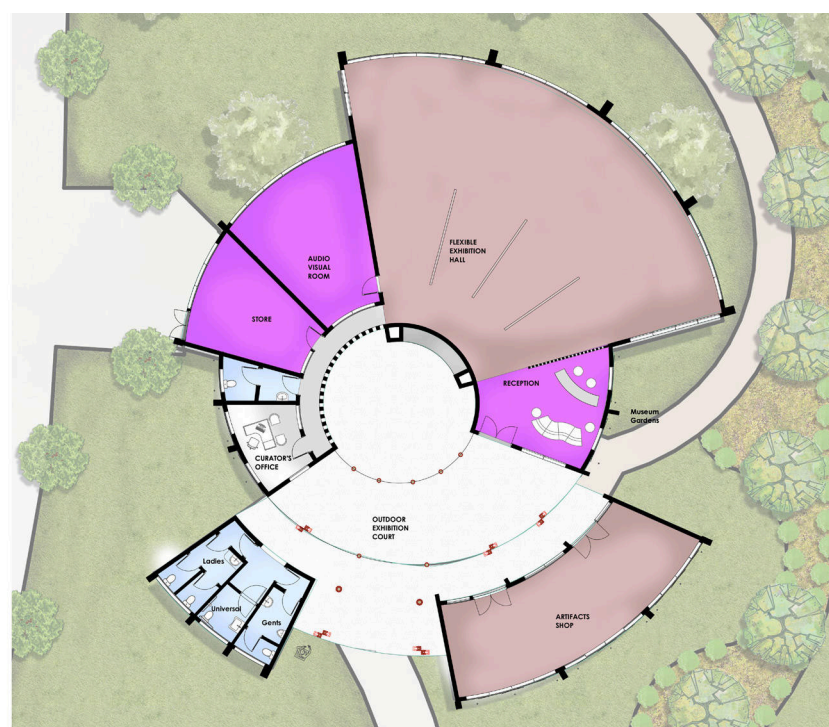
THE LIBRARY



Elevation
Scale 1:200



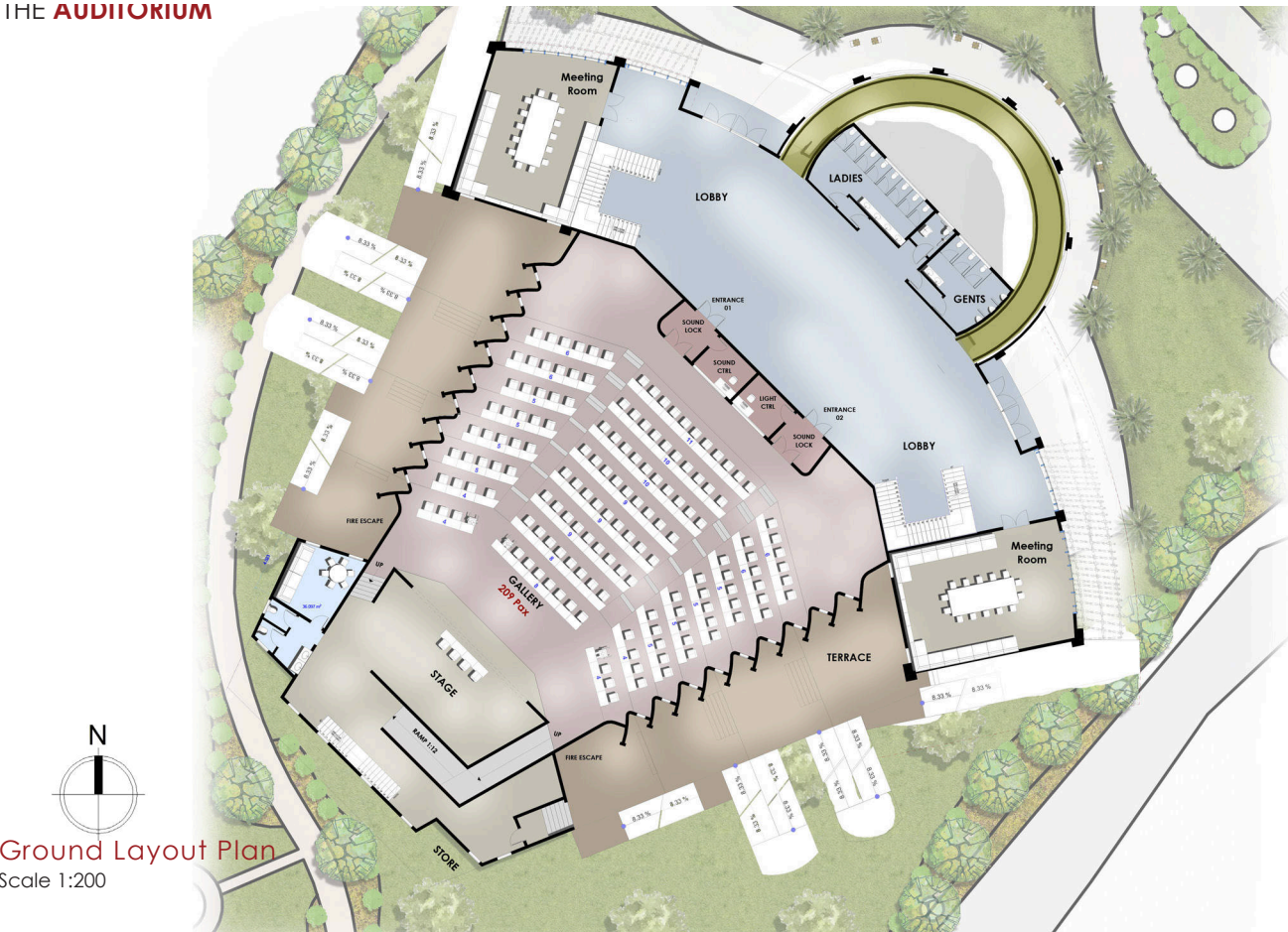
THE MUSEUM

An architectural rendering of a modern museum building. The structure features a wide, flat, light-colored roof that extends over a large, open space. The walls are primarily composed of reddish-brown bricks, with sections of stone masonry. Large windows are visible, some with dark frames. A prominent white sculpture of a nude female figure stands on a small circular base in the foreground. The building is surrounded by lush green landscaping, including various shrubs and trees. A paved walkway leads through the grounds, and several silhouetted figures of people are shown walking, suggesting a public space. The sky is blue with scattered white clouds.

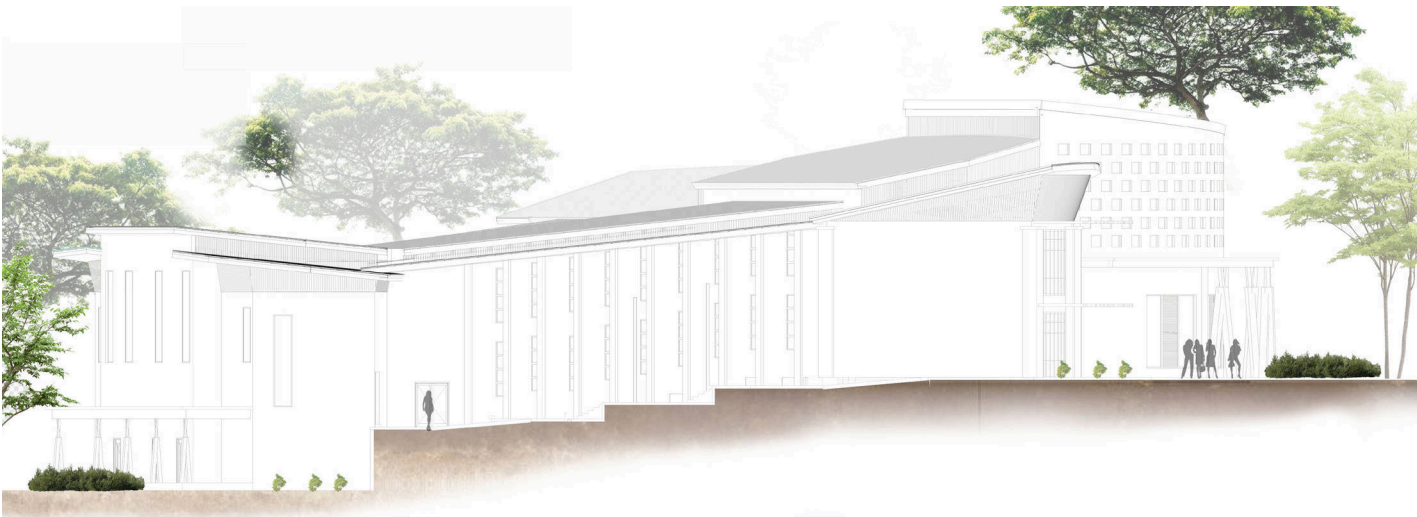
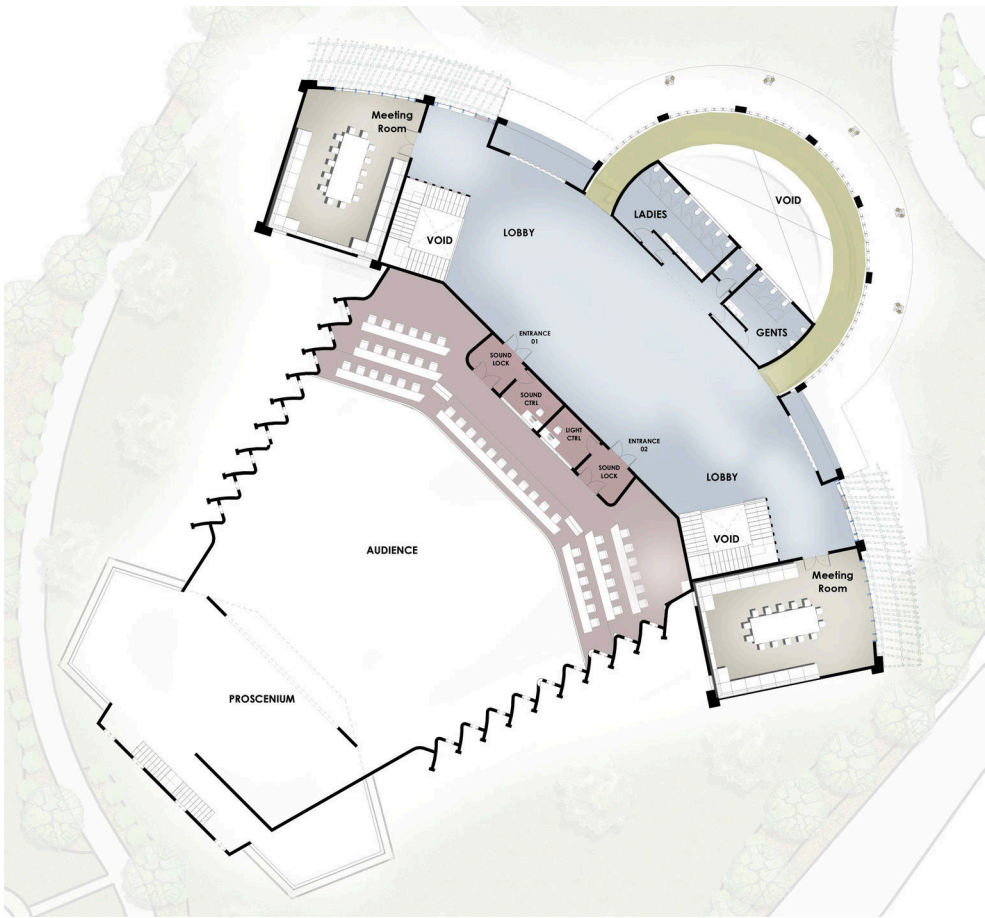
THE AUDITORIUM



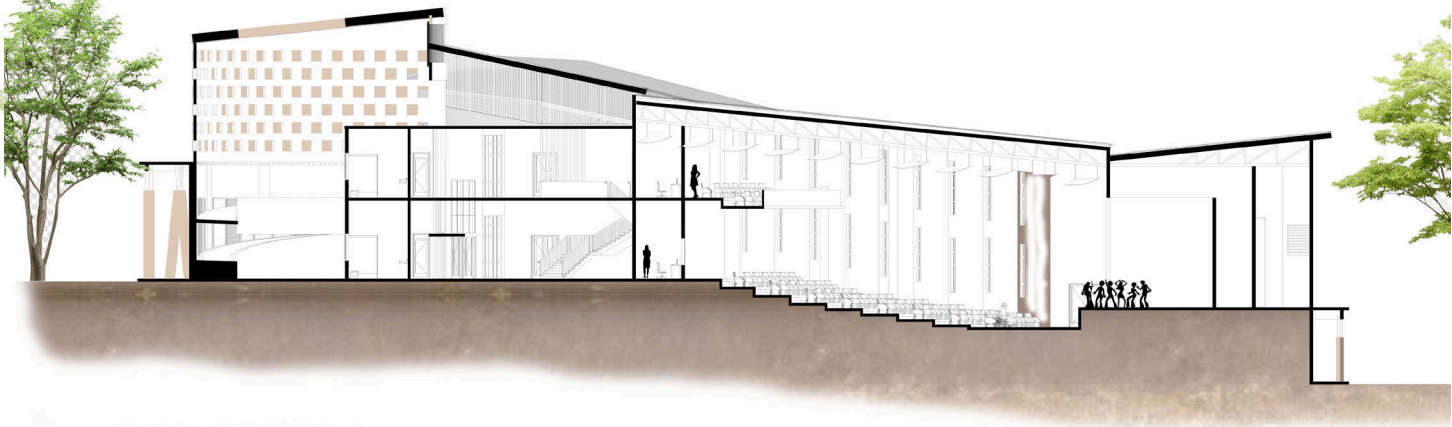
THE AUDITORIUM



Ground Layout Plan
Scale 1:200

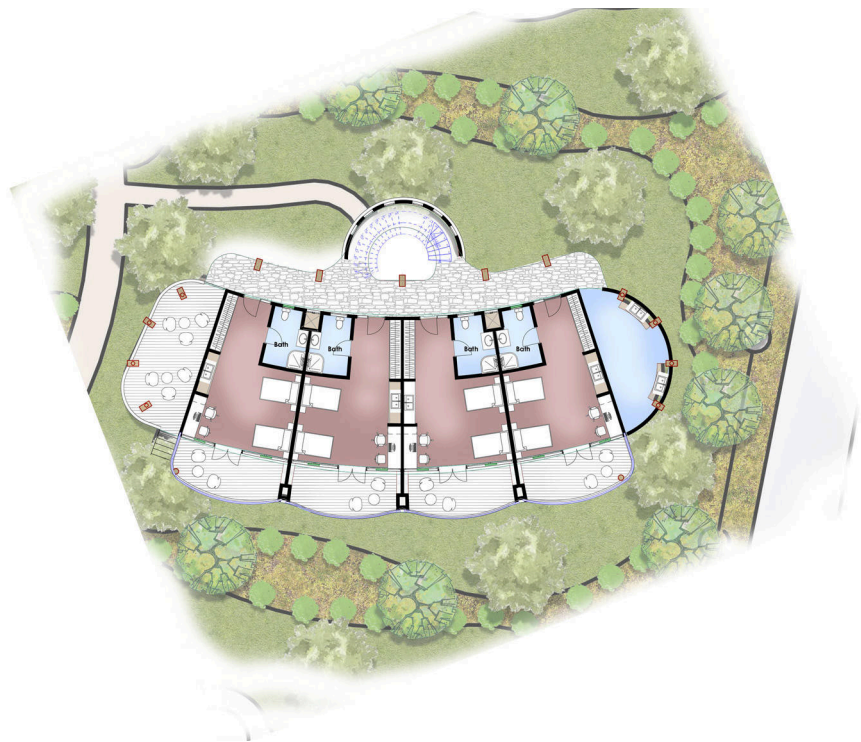


Elevation 01
Scale 1:200

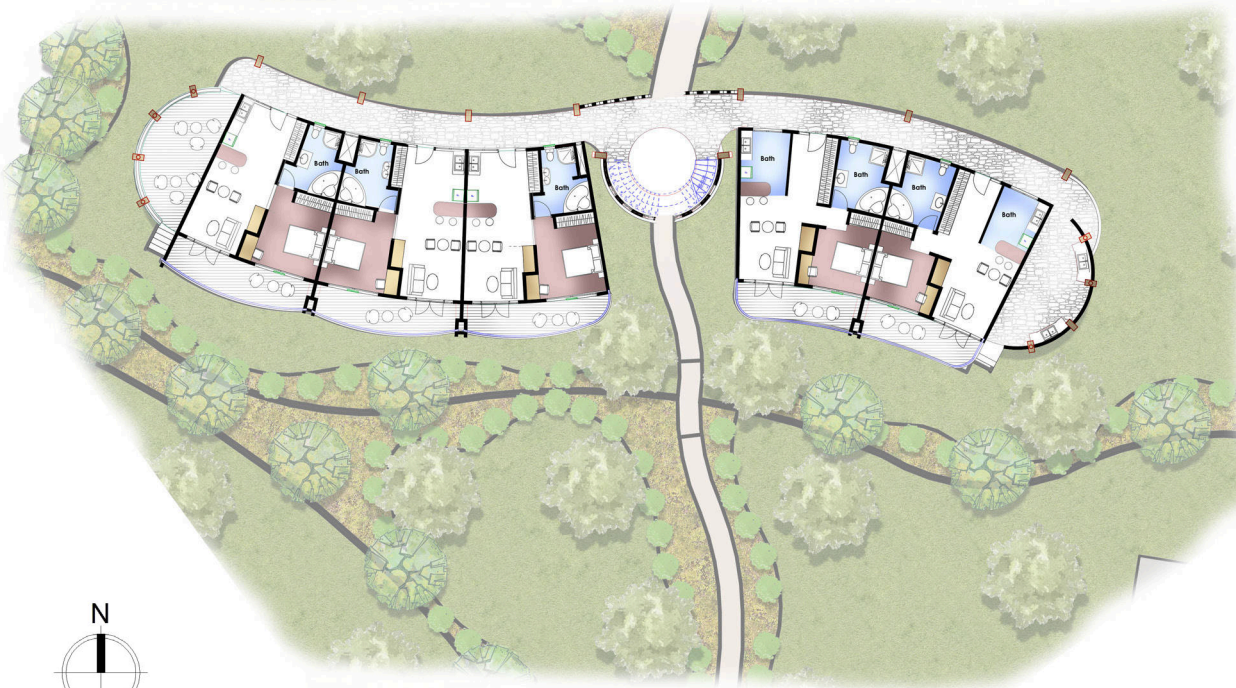


Elevation 02
Scale 1:200

STANDARD ROOMS

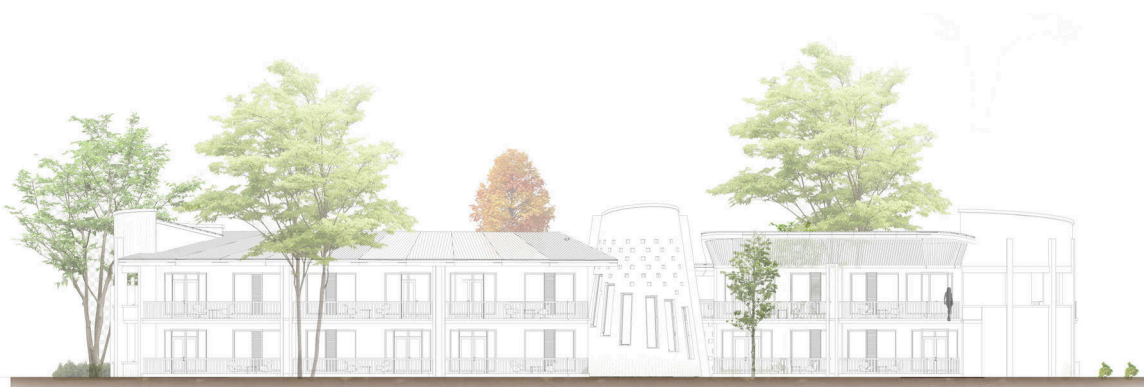


Typical layout Plan
Scale 1:200



Ty
Scale 1:200

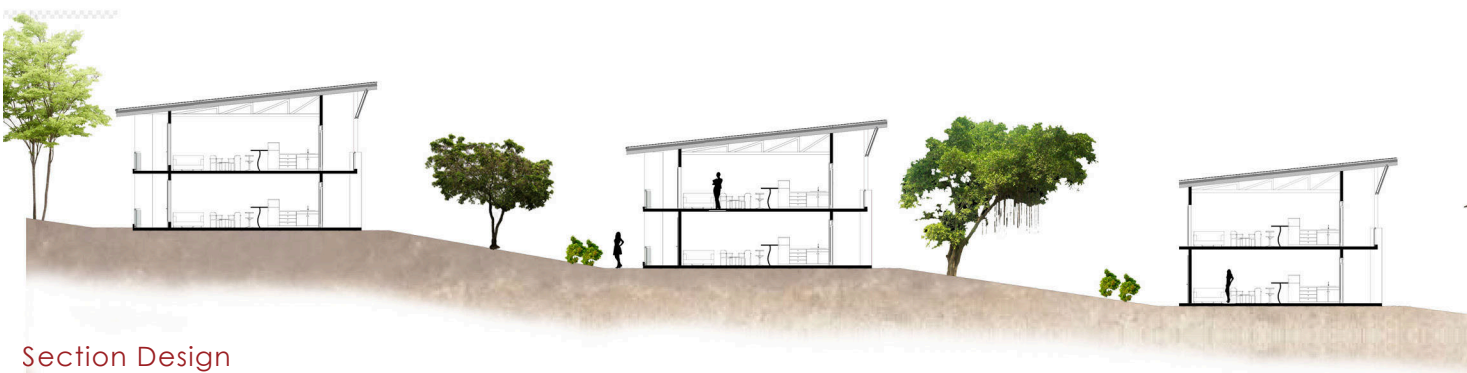
† Plan



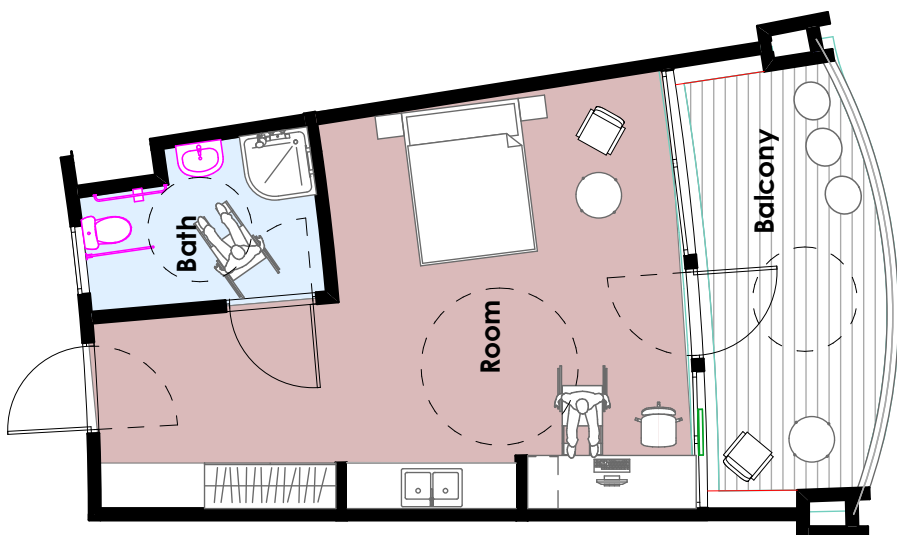
Elevation
Scale 1:200



Elevation
Scale 1:200



Section Design
Scale 1:200





LANDSCAPE DESIGN STRATEGIES

Landscape design on the healing farm captures the following main ideas:

1. Sculpture and Outdoor Art

The design incorporates sculpture extensively as seen on the masterplan. Sculptures on site celebrate African culture and the ideas of the Feminist Movement. The main entrance is line with sculpture and the main monument serves as a key element on site.

2. Water

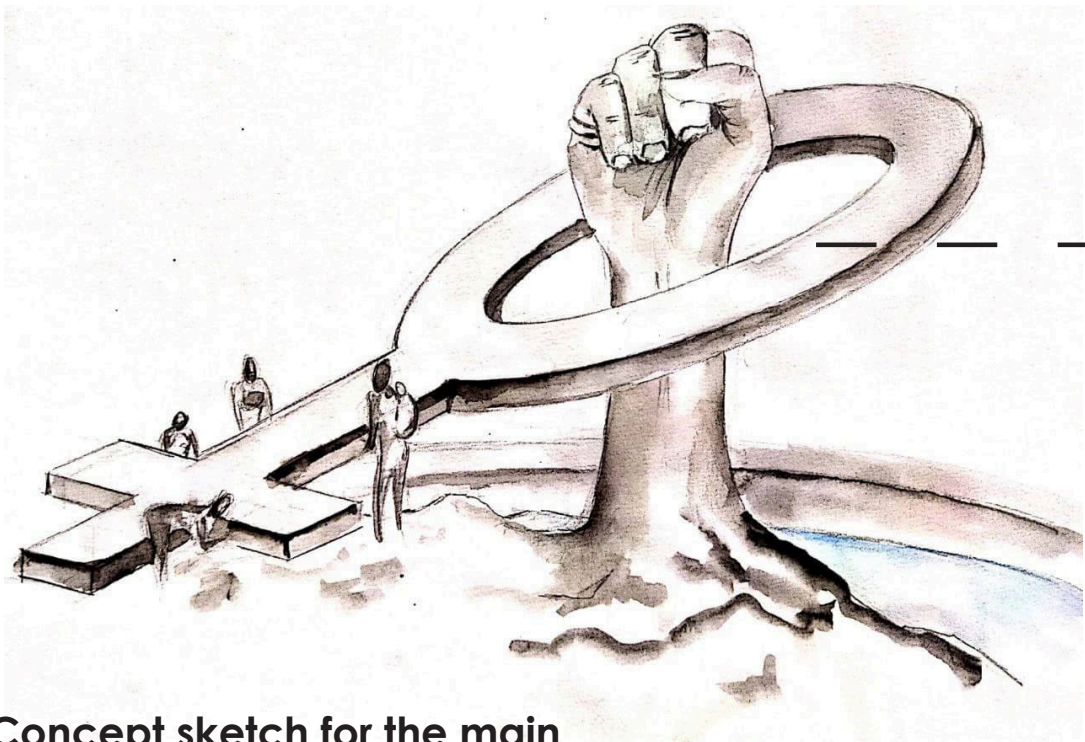
The landscape design uses water extensively to promote the healing effect of the farm. The therapeutic effects of water are captured in the design of the meditations gardens around the water pan. The pool, river and fountains within the site also promotes well being for users visiting the

3. Native Plants

The landscaping concept uses native plants that thrive in the dry climate of the site. The plants are extensively used along the boundary lines and gardens. The use of plants increases the healing effects of the farm.

4. Edible Gardens

The landscape design also incorporates an edible garden of herbs and fruit trees. The gardens, while serving a practical function, help create better spaces for the users.



Concept sketch for the main monument on site.

LANDSCAPE DESIGN

